

March 24, 2026

Hiring Committee
Center for American Progress

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Director of Economic Analysis position at the Center for American Progress. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, where my research focuses on macroeconomics, household finance, and inequality using quantitative models and micro-level data. I am particularly drawn to this role because it combines rigorous economic analysis with a clear policy mission: producing research that informs decisions, shapes public debate, and promotes an economy that works for all.

My research agenda centers on understanding how economic policies and market structures affect household outcomes. In my job market paper, I develop a heterogeneous-agent life-cycle model to study wealth accumulation and inequality, incorporating heterogeneity in returns and income risk. This work is designed to generate policy-relevant insights about the distributional consequences of economic environments and policy interventions. In complementary work, I use micro and panel data from the Health and Retirement Study to study how trust and financial performance interact over time, applying econometric methods suited to panel data and causal identification. These projects have given me extensive experience working with large datasets, conducting quantitative analysis, and translating empirical results into meaningful economic insights.

A central focus of my work is communicating complex analysis clearly and effectively. I routinely produce research summaries, visualizations, and written reports that distill technical findings into accessible conclusions for broader audiences. As a teaching assistant in data-driven and quantitative finance courses, I have also worked closely with students to explain economic concepts and empirical methods, an experience that has strengthened my ability to communicate across levels of technical expertise. I am particularly motivated by the opportunity to bring this skill set into a policy environment where timely, well-communicated analysis can directly shape policy discussions.

I am especially excited about American Progress' work on affordability, labor markets, and economic mobility. I share the organization's commitment to using economic analysis to advance equitable growth and improve economic security. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute by developing rigorous, policy-relevant research, collaborating across teams, and helping mentor early-career staff as they build their analytical skills.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would be honored to contribute to American Progress' mission of advancing an economy that works for all.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards